# Theisen Sanders

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**SUMMARY**

Founder and engineering leader with 15 years of experience building reliable, full-stack systems and supporting teams through growth and change. Comfortable owning architecture and driving technical direction across teams and org boundaries.

**ON MY MIND**

- AI-ready codebases with safe self-healing and recursive improvement
- Deliberate AI integration into established platforms
- Efficient, maintainable AI-generated code

**EXPERIENCE**

## Cove Teams, Inc. — Oct 2024 – Present

*Early-stage startup developing software to improve pediatric therapy outcomes for developmentally delayed children. Inspired by my nephew, Liam.*

**Founder & Chief Technology Officer** – Chicago, IL — Full-time since Jun 2026

- Lead technical strategy for an AI platform that lets clinicians focus on care
- Architected and shipped a HIPAA-compliant web application
- Built a cross-platform mobile app for Android & iOS (Flutter)
- Implemented a media pipeline that ingests, processes, and analyzes images and video

## Workiva, Inc. (NYSE: WK) — Nov 2011 – May 2026

*SaaS platform for connected financial, regulatory, and sustainability reporting with over 6,000 enterprise customers worldwide.*

**Director of Engineering** – Chicago, IL — Oct 2025 – May 2026

- Managed 4 teams and 20 engineers, directly and through engineering managers, delivering carbon accounting and sustainability reporting products
- Led technical roadmap planning for the 80-engineer sustainability organization; co-presented a keynote to Workiva's 800-person technology organization
- Championed Claude Code adoption and founded the internal community and best practices for AI-assisted development

**Senior Engineering Manager** – Chicago, IL — Nov 2022 – Oct 2025

- Led two growth teams to launch Workiva's fit-for-purpose sustainability solution, growing to 720 customers in 2 years
- Doubled team size in 10 months by streamlining recruiting, hiring, and onboarding
- Cut engineers' support response and resolution times, earning a seat on the org-wide training committee
- Designed, built, and shipped a public REST API, opening the platform to partners and more customer workflows
- Mentored direct reports, with 8 earning promotions under my leadership

**Engineering Manager** – Amsterdam, NL Aug 2019 – Nov 2022

- Started Workiva's first EU engineering team to drive EMEA expansion, then built a succession plan and handed off leadership before returning to the U.S.
- Designed and shipped a multilingual document-collaboration tool, later patented as Translation Comments Flowback (US20230123555A1)
- Led internationalization of the Workiva platform to reach global markets
- Launched the Workiva Marketplace for distribution of pre-built, installable artifacts

**Senior Software Engineer** – Denver, CO Aug 2016 – May 2019

- Served as tech lead for a GRC product line team, making key architecture and design decisions
- Built and maintained a web service on our in-house graph DB to support client-facing apps; used and extended by multiple teams
- Automated build and test pipelines with Docker; reviewed code for security issues
- Partnered with Microsoft engineers to integrate Microsoft 365 for the web (Office Online) into the platform

**Software Engineer** – Boulder, CO Jan 2013 – Aug 2016

- Built a multithreaded user notification system with high throughput and intelligent bundling to reduce noise and improve UX
- Led design and implementation of Workiva's first mobile-friendly SPA (AngularJS), covering both UX and engineering; ran with minimal upkeep until 2023
- Built prototypes that ran safely inside customer accounts on live data, so customers could evaluate new workflows with their own content and no risk to production

**Quality Test Engineer Intern** – Ames, IA Nov 2011 – Jan 2013

- Built a Selenium framework that let non-developers write and run functional tests

## PATENTS

*Systems and Methods for Translation Comments Flowback* May 2023
US20230123555A1

- Built a machine translation workflow for multi-language document reviews
- Anchored translations to source text and surfaced reviewer feedback in the original document

## EDUCATION

*Bachelor of Science in Computer Science* Aug 2010 – Dec 2013
Iowa State University – Ames, IA

## TECHNICAL SKILLS

***Languages***
Go, Python, Dart, TypeScript, Kotlin/Java

***Cloud, DevOps & Observability***
AWS, Docker, Kubernetes, GitHub Actions, OpenTelemetry

***Data & ML***
PostgreSQL, Graph DBs, BigQuery, RAG / Vector DBs, LLMs

***APIs & Messaging***
OpenAPI, GraphQL, gRPC, Kafka, SQS

***Frontend & Testing***
React, Flutter, HTMX, Playwright, Vitest